Ronald E. Straight

Senior Software Engineer

I bring decades of experience in high-performance backend engineering, from C and Perl to modern Golang and Kubernetes-native Java and Rust microservices. AI coding agents are good collaborators, but they still need someone to tell them when they're about to rimraf something important — with agentic coding you get my unique human experience plus a team of masochistic junior engineers to do all the boring stuff. Work is where I want to swim with my fellow clever rubber ducks.

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github.com/ronstr8

ronstr8 (LinkedIn)

ronstr8 (GitHub)

Work

Senior Software Engineer

Synacor
Feb 2019 – Oct 2024
Buffalo, NY

- Served as primary developer for the Golang-based Mailbox Locator Service, part of a global team converting the Zimbra email/collaboration system to a multi-tenant Kubernetes-native service on Oracle Cloud Infrastructure.
- Contributed to core Zimbra engineering, working on legacy Java codebase with extensive use of remote debuggers.
- Leveraged Golang and Kubernetes expertise to migrate several hundred million user mailboxes — containing sensitive personal communications — from bare-metal servers to Zimbra on Kubernetes, maintaining data integrity throughout.

Senior Software Engineer

Adblade / Solve Media
May 2013 – Jan 2019
Buffalo, NY

- Built a high-availability RESTful Data Management Platform (DMP) using Java/Netty, supporting sub-millisecond responses at scale.
- Developed custom dispatching annotations and supported multiple HTTP methods for consumer targeting resources stored in Redis.

- Ported a legacy image conversion REST server from Ruby to Java and migrated a Solaris data center environment to AWS.

Software Engineer III, Team Leader

Kanoodle / Pulse360 / Seevast
Nov 2004 – Apr 2013
Buffalo, NY

- Contributed Oracle-specific enhancements upstream to the DBIx::Class open-source ORM framework while developing heavy Perl ad-serving applications.
- Performed Oracle DBA duties, including DDL review and Oracle analytic functions.
- Created a 'RoboDeploy' system for multi-threaded deployment to over 100 servers.

Co-Founder, Software Developer

Netsville
Jun 1994 – Nov 2004
Rochester, NY

- Co-founded Netsville and developed 'Hazel,' one of the first e-commerce checkout systems, written in C with a templating language (HZML).

Projects

Logodal

Jan 2026 – Present

Multiplayer whimsical word game running on a kind cluster in my bedroom. In active development.

- Developed a custom wordlist server in Rust to handle building lexicons and their rules for any language.
- Configured networking and TLS termination for public access to the local Kubernetes cluster at logodal.com.
- Implemented real-time gameplay mechanics using Perl, plus simple intelligent dummy players.
- Use in-cluster ollama to generate personalized quips for the AI players

Kubernetes Minikube Helm Perl Rust React Networking

Antigravity Claude Codex

Card Shoggoths

Jan 2026 – Present

Multiplayer poker game with a bit of cosmic horror. In active development.

- Implemented the game server in Golang, with a bare bones index.html/css frontend.
- Configured networking for public access to the local Kubernetes cluster at poker.fazigu.org.

Kubernetes Minikube Helm Golang Networking Antigravity

Skills

Programming Languages

Bash Java Perl Golang C

Python Rust Javascript

Technologies

Kubernetes Git HTML CSS

REST API OCI AWS Helm

Docker Node.js LLM

Databases

Oracle MySQL PostgreSQL

MariaDB Redis MongoDB

Frameworks

Mason DBIx::Class Netty

Dropwizard React Spring Boot

Coding Agents

Claude Codex OpenClaw

Aider Antigravity

Interests

Personal Interests

Hacking (in the ESR sense) Tinkering with gadgets

Fallout/76, Starfield, Cyberpunk Arguing with AI The Love Boat